

Challenge Write-Up Template

Challenge Information

Student Name	Evallo, Daniella Kim N.
Section / Class	BSIT-3G
Challenge Name	Printer Shares
Category	General Skills
Points / Difficulty	Easy
Date Solved	08/09/2026
Flag Format Given	picoCTF{...}

1. Challenge Description

The challenge was about a network printer that had an important file sent to it by mistake. The printer was running on mysterious-sea.picoctf.net using port 52274. I needed to connect to the printer service, find the shared files, and get the flag from the correct file.

2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

I checked the challenge prompt and the hints first. The hints pointed to SMB and suggested using smbclient or smbutil. Since the challenge gave me a hostname and port, I first checked if the port was reachable. After that, I enumerated the SMB shares and looked for a public share where the file could be located.

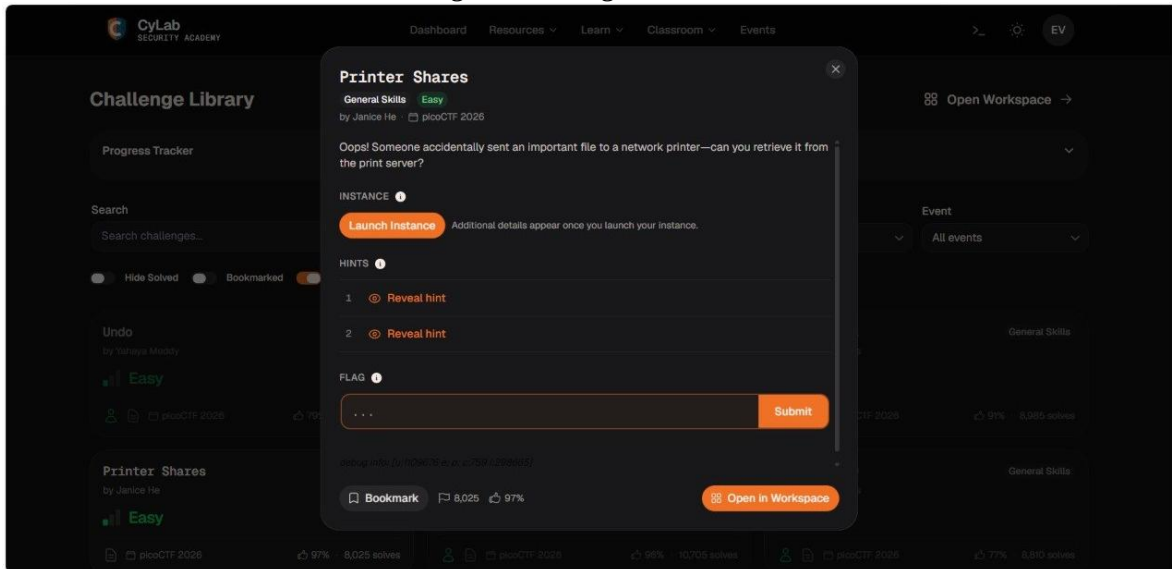
3. Tools and Commands Used

Tool / Command	What it was used for	Result / Output
nc -vz mysterious-sea.picoctf.net 52274	Check if the challenge service was reachable.	The connection to port 52274 succeeded.
smbclient -L //mysterious-sea.picoctf.net -p 52274 -N	List the SMB shares without a password.	The server showed shares and IPC\$. The shares share was a public guest share.
smbclient //mysterious-sea.picoctf.net/shares -p 52274 -N	Connect to the public shares share.	I got an SMB prompt and could access the share.
ls	See what files were inside the share.	I found dummy.txt and flag.txt.
get flag.txt	Download flag.txt from the share.	The file was downloaded successfully.
cat flag.txt	Read the downloaded flag file.	The flag was displayed in the terminal.

4. Solution Walkthrough

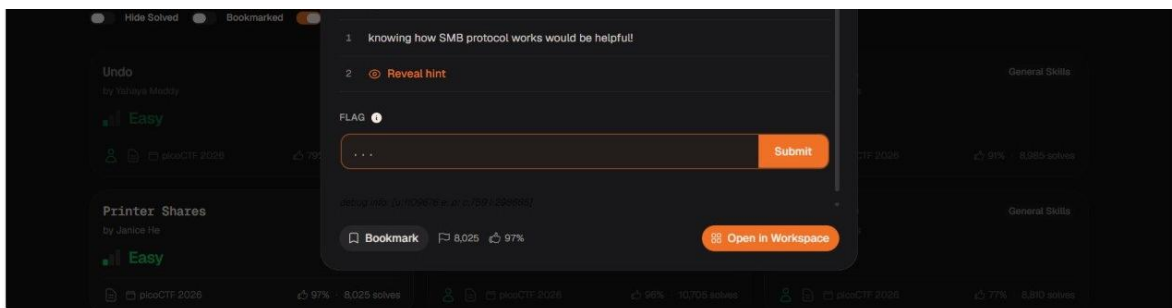
Step 1

First, opened the Printer Shares challenge and checked the instructions. I looked at the information given on the page so I could understand what the challenge was asking me to do.



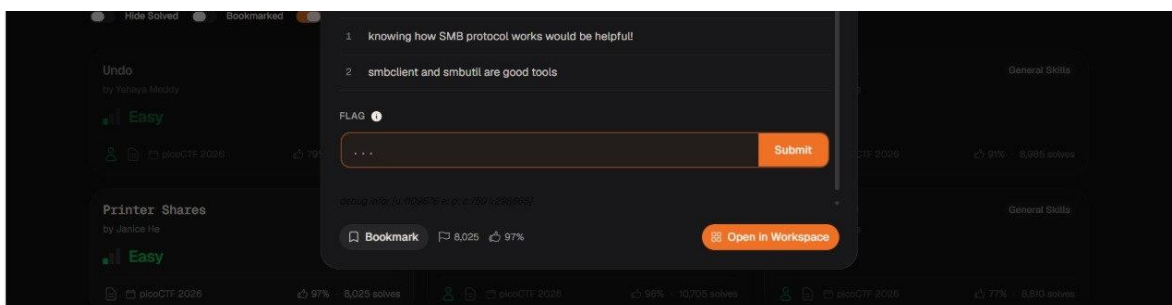
Step 2

Next, I checked the hint. It mentioned **SMB tools**, so I understood that I needed to look for an SMB share where the file might be stored



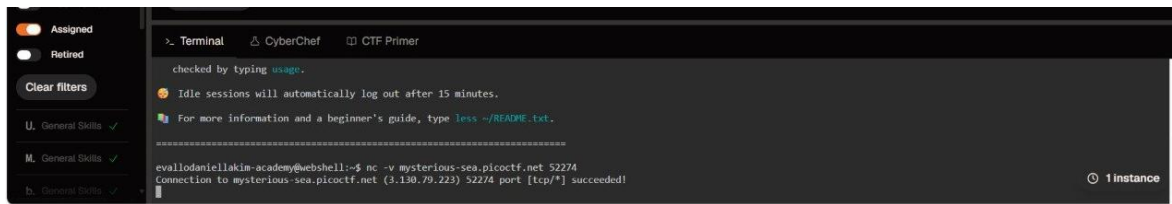
Step 3

After checking the instructions, launched the challenge instance. I took note of the hostname and port because I needed these details for the connection.



Step 4

Next, checked if the printer service was reachable using ``nc -vz mysterious-sea.picocftf.net 52274``. This command checks if the given port is open and responding. The connection was successful, so continued with the **SMB commands**.



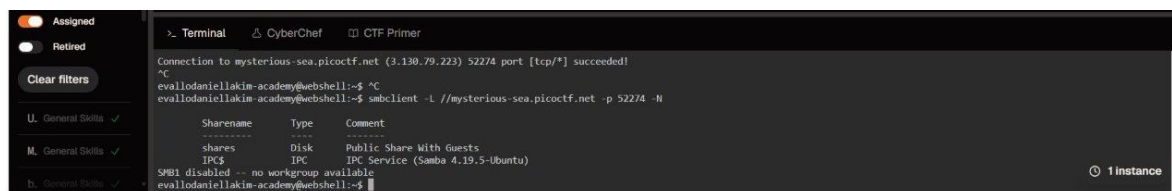
```
>. Terminal  CyberChef  CTF Primer

checked by typing usage.
Idle sessions will automatically log out after 15 minutes.
For more information and a beginner's guide, type less ~/README.txt.

evallodaniellakim-academy@webshell:~$ nc -v mysterious-sea.picocftf.net 52274
Connection to mysterious-sea.picocftf.net (3.130.79.223) 52274 port [tcp/*] succeeded!
```

Step 5

After confirming the connection, used ``smbclient -L //mysterious-sea.picocftf.net -p 52274 -N`` to list the available SMB shares. The ``-L`` option lists the shares and ``-N`` lets me connect without entering a password. I found a public share named ``shares``.



```
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Connection to mysterious-sea.picocftf.net (3.130.79.223) 52274 port [tcp/*] succeeded!
evallodaniellakim-academy@webshell:~$ ^C
evallodaniellakim-academy@webshell:~$ smbclient -L //mysterious-sea.picocftf.net -p 52274 -N

Sharename      Type      Comment
-----
shares         Disk      Public Share With Guests
IPC$           IPC       IPC Service (Samba 4.19.5-Ubuntu)
SMB1 disabled -- no workgroup available

evallodaniellakim-academy@webshell:~$
```

Step 6

Then, connect to the ``shares`` folder using **smbclient** without a password. This gave us access to the files inside the public SMB share.



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>. Terminal  CyberChef  CTF Primer

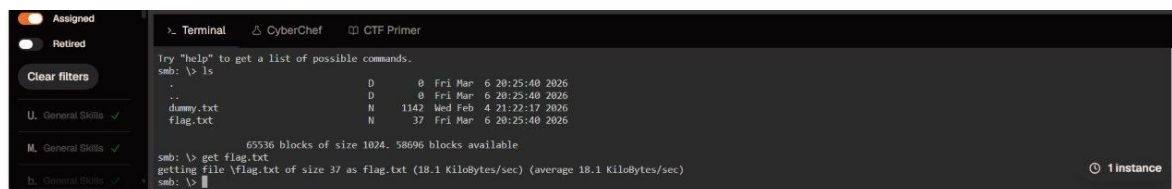
evallodaniellakim-academy@webshell:~$ ^C
evallodaniellakim-academy@webshell:~$ smbclient -L //mysterious-sea.picocftf.net -p 52274 -N

Sharename      Type      Comment
-----
shares         Disk      Public Share With Guests
IPC$           IPC       IPC Service (Samba 4.19.5-Ubuntu)
SMB1 disabled -- no workgroup available

evallodaniellakim-academy@webshell:~$ smbclient //mysterious-sea.picocftf.net/shares -p 52274 -N
Try "help" to get a list of possible commands.
smb: \>
```

Step 7

Once I was inside the share, used ``ls`` to see the available files. You found ``dummy.txt`` and ``flag.txt``. Since the challenge was asking for the flag, ``flag.txt`` was the file I needed.



```
smb: \> ls

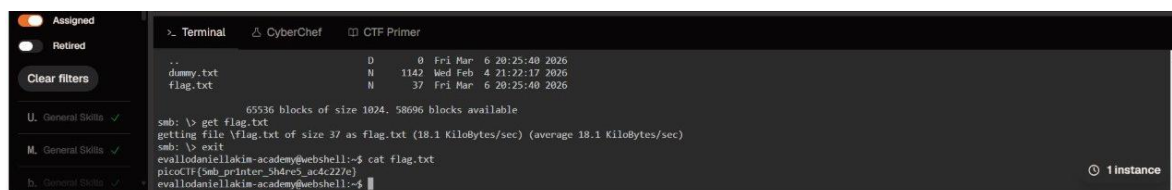
.                D      0  Fri Mar 6 20:25:40 2026
..               D      0  Fri Mar 6 20:25:40 2026
dummy.txt        N     1142 Wed Feb 4 21:22:17 2026
flag.txt         N      37  Fri Mar 6 20:25:40 2026

65536 blocks of size 1024, 58696 blocks available

smb: \> get flag.txt
getting file \flag.txt of size 37 as flag.txt (18.1 KiloBytes/sec) (average 18.1 KiloBytes/sec)
smb: \>
```

Step 8

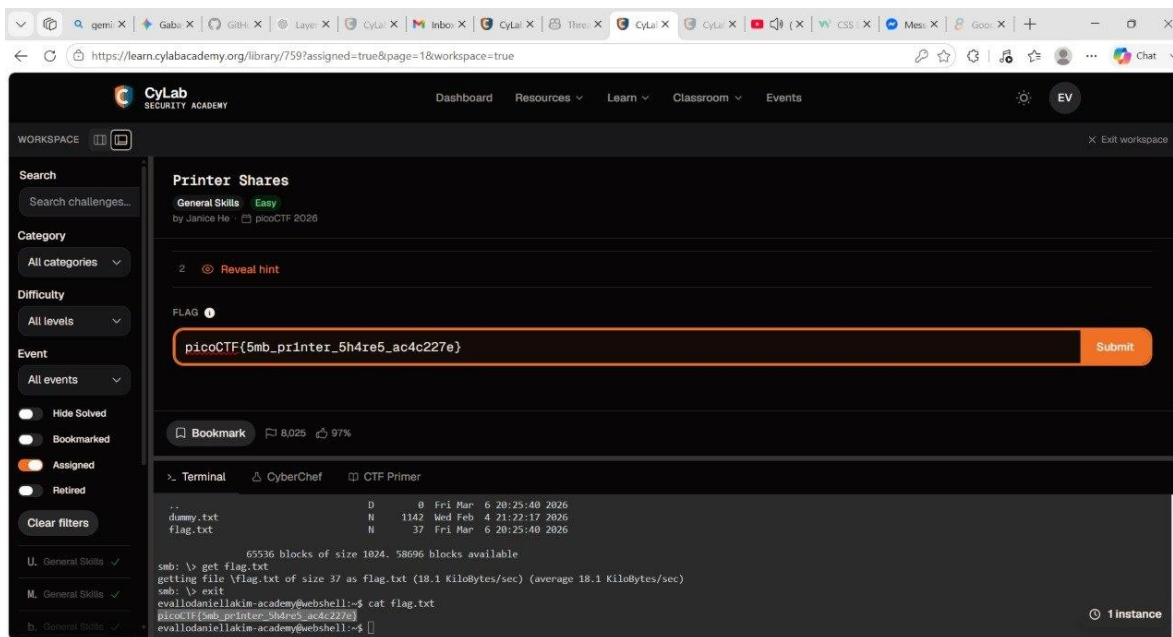
After finding the file, used ``get flag.txt`` to download it from the SMB share to my terminal environment. The file was downloaded successfully.



```
smb: \> get flag.txt
getting file \flag.txt of size 37 as flag.txt (18.1 KiloBytes/sec) (average 18.1 KiloBytes/sec)
smb: \> exit
evallodaniellakim-academy@webshell:~$ cat flag.txt
pic0CTF{5mb_pr1nter_sh4re5_ac4c227e}
evallodaniellakim-academy@webshell:~$
```

Step 9

Finally, used `cat flag.txt` to display the contents of the downloaded file.



5. Flag

picoCTF{5mb_pr1nter_5h4re5_ac4c227e}

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

This challenge taught me how to enumerate SMB shares and access a guest-accessible share. I also learned that checking public shares is important because files can sometimes be left accessible without a password.

7. References

[picoCTF 2026 | Denton's Blog](#), **OpenAI. ChatGPT.** <https://chatgpt.com/>,

YouTube – picoCTF 2026 / CyLab – Printer Shares

https://youtu.be/_Qqe9tmHHeI?si=s3jX5_9NRjEBXirY